

FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH



BELLTOWER *March 2026*



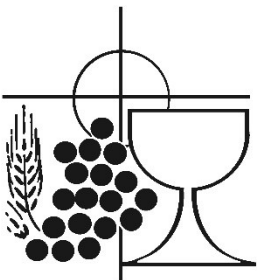
From the Pastor

I love watching for the signs that spring is on its way. The buds are just starting to appear on trees, or the tips of flowers are just peaking their head out of the ground to test if spring is coming. The sighting of a robin means my eyes aren't deceiving me, spring is coming (I haven't yet seen a robin this year—but I know some of you have, so I will trust you). This slow transforming of seasons usually happens as we are journeying through Lent, on our way to celebrating Easter. It is very fitting that we are able to slowly watch the earth reawaken as we head to the celebration of the resurrection.

The reminders of spring can serve as reminders from God that like the earth is transformed, we are also transformed. Isaiah 43: 19 says, "See, I am doing a new thing! Now it springs up; do you not perceive it?" We aren't meant to stay the same, God opens our hearts, our eyes and our ears to learn to love like God does. We are on this journey together, as we serve together as God's hands and feet in the world.

As the changing season springs up all around us, I pray that it reminds us how God is bringing new life, and helping us to be transformed. I pray that we are open to that work of transformation, and to listening for how God wants to use us.

Nikelle



At-Home Communion

If you are interested in having Nikelle and an Elder bring you communion at home, please let Nikelle know.

2025 Annual Report

Copies are now available at church. If you would like one mailed to you please contact the office.



Palm Sunday March 29 @ 9:30 am brunch and conversation following worship the good news is... inspiring us to act	Maundy Thursday April 2 @ 6 pm at FPC with First Baptist Church the good news is... even Judas gets his feet washed	Good Friday April 3 @ 6 pm at First Baptist Church the good news is... revealed through nonviolence	Easter Sunday April 5 @ 9:30 am A resurrection celebration the good news is... alive in the world
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Each Wednesday we join in prayer as a community.

We invite you to join us.

"The Lord is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit." — Psalm 34:18

Lord, fill my heart with joy and gratitude this March. Help me recognize Your blessings in every situation, rejoice in Your faithfulness, and express thankfulness daily. Replace discontent with contentment, and let my life reflect Your goodness. May my heart overflow with appreciation for Your love, mercy, and guidance. Strengthen me to walk in joy and glorify You in all circumstances. In Jesus' name, Amen. Mary Coulsen





Safety Update

We have a new doorbell that rings in the office, along with the fellowship hall and BLINKS in the sanctuary to let us know that someone needs to be greeted at the door. We hope this will eliminate people getting locked out! In general, the main doors will be unlocked on Sunday between 8 & 9 a.m. (depending on if the choir is practicing) and will be locked about 9:40/9:45 for safety reasons. We also have added a chime when the door opens or closes that rings in the fellowship hall (it is a shorter ding-dong than the doorbell) to alert those present that someone has entered the building. Our hope is to balance both safety and being welcoming.



MISSION WITNESS

Pop Tops

The Mission/Witness Committee is collecting tabs from the top of cans, including pop (soda), sparkling water, canned veggies, soup, pet food, etc. There is a container in the fellowship hall where you can add them, which will be dropped off at the Ronald McDonald House @ Iowa Health Care on occasion. This helps to support their program of providing housing for parents whose children are undergoing medical treatment, so that parents can stay with their child and support them. If you have any questions, please ask Evelyn Thomas.

Mini Food Pantry

We will continue collecting and delivering items once a month for the food pantry in 2026. Please place your donations in the blue cloth bags under the stairway near the parking lot entrance to the church. Or you can take items to the pantry on your own. It is directly behind the library in a wooden shed. Shelves for cans, etc. are behind the left door. A refrigerator/freezer is behind the right door. Be sure to put nonfood items such as dish soap on the bottom shelf away from food items. Because it is available 24 hours a day, it is a convenient way to drop things off as you are in the area. Of course, we are happy to continue to deliver donations that you bring to the church.

What can be recycled?

All plastic must be clean, dry and free of food residue.



Bags for Benches....

You may have noticed the sign and the bin that has already been overflowing that are in the narthex area. We are collecting many kinds of plastic bags which will be transformed into a garden bench to be placed in the community garden. So we have a double win - of helping the environment by keeping plastic out of the landfills and oceans as well as adding a place to take a break in the garden. Items that qualify are listed in the graphic found above.



Meals on Wheels

A sincere thank you to our volunteers who served Meals on Wheels on January 26 to February 6, 2026. Mike Barney, Allen & Bonnie Cumberland, Peg Hamilton, Phil Devers & Susie Jones, Chuck & Vicki Jones, Jane Landreth, Rick Lucas, Tammy Olson, Phil & Toni Vella.

Presbyterian Women

MARCH 2026 SCHEDULE OF WORSHIP HELPERS

March 1, 2026 2nd Sunday in Lent
Musician: Carolyn McBride
Elder & Liturgist: Susie Smith
Ushers: Bonnie Cumberland
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship: Donuts
Communion Preparer: Sheri Hill & Gayle Topping

March 22, 2026 5th Sunday in Lent
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder & Liturgist: Evelyn Thomas
Ushers:
A/V: Angie Montague & Phil Vella
Fellowship Host:

March 8, 2026 3rd Sunday in Lent
Musician: Carolyn McBride
Elder & Liturgist: Chuck Jones
Ushers: Susie Jones & Phil Devers
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship Host: Vicki & Chuck Jones

March 29, 2026 Palm/Passion Sunday
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder: Phil Vella & Liturgist: Toni Vella
Ushers:
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship: Palm Sunday Brunch Hosted by Christian Education

March 15, 2026 4th Sunday in Lent
Musician: Anne Badger
Elder: Phil Devers
Ushers:
A/V: Angie Montague & Lance Schaefer
Fellowship Host: Sheri Hill & Gayle Topping

April 5, 2026 Easter Sunday
Musician: Anne Badger
Elder & Liturgist: Lance Schaefer
Ushers:
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
<i>A JOYOUS EASTER</i> <i>to You and Your Family</i>
Communion Preparer: Susie Jones & Phil Devers

If you would like to help with our Sunday tasks let Pastor or Lois know which one and they will connect you with that scheduler. Thank you!

March 2026 Birthdays & Anniversaries

Birthdays

03/02 Andrew Dempsey

03/03 Jack Dempsey

03/11 David Coers

03/21 Abbey Schaefer

03/29 Lucy Beckman

03/31 Allen Cumberland

03/03 Mike Barney

03/10 Jon Dempsey

03/15 Mark Dempsey

03/28 Ashley Hawbaker

03/30 DeeAnn Wendt



Anniversaries

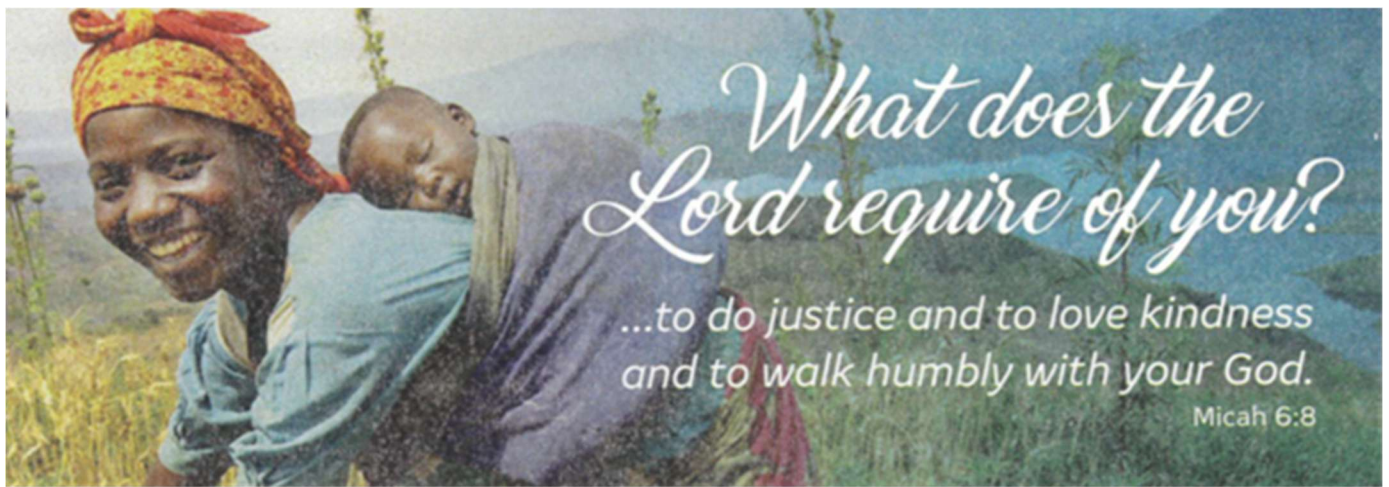
03/04 Bruce & Carol Bennett

03/29 Chuck & Vicki Jones

ONE GREAT HOUR of SHARING Special Offering

We are the Church, Together."

Gifts are due by Easter Sunday, April 5, 2026.



March 2026

Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
1 Second Sunday of Lent 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour 11:00am Lenten Study 6:00pm Community Lenten Service - Grace United Methodist Church	2 6:00pm Quilters Meeting	3 12:30pm Worship Committee Meeting 3:30pm Mission/Witness Committee 4:30pm Finance & Property Committee	4 5:00pm Christian Education Committee	5 4:30pm Caregiver Support Meeting	6	7
8 Third Sunday of Lent 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour 11:00am Lenten Study 6:00pm Community Lenten Service - First Baptist Church	9 1:00pm PEO AC Meeting	10 9:30am Innermission Committee	11	12 5:30pm PEO Chapter KM Meeting	13	14
15 Fourth Sunday of Lent 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour 11:00am Session Meeting 11:00am Lenten Study 6:00pm Community Lenten Service - Sauk Valley Community Church	16 1:00pm PW Bible Study	17	18 Newsletter Deadline	19 1:00pm Book Club PEO AC 4:30pm Caregiver Support Meeting	20	21
22 Fifth Sunday of Lent 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour 11:00am Lenten Study 6:00pm Community Lenten Service - Immanuel Lutheran Church	23	24	25	26	27	28
29 Palm/Passion Sunday 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Palm Sunday Breakfast 11:00am Lenten Study 6:00pm Hymn Sing - Dixon Church of the Brethren	30	31				



**First Presbyterian Church of Dixon
Sunday Service: 9:30 a.m.**

Find us on Facebook & YouTube.

www.fpcdixon.com

Pastor: Rev. Nikelle Johnson
Administrative Assistant: Lois Grimm
Custodian: Julie Glenn

Music Director: Kathleen Schaefer
A/V Tech: Carolyn McBride

OUR PURPOSE STATEMENT

As followers of Jesus Christ, we will, by our intentional actions,
seek a deeper relationship with God,
listen for the Spirit's call to mission in our community,
and prayerfully lead others to know the joy of God's love,
and to realize God's purpose for life's journey.

